

GENERAL STUDIES - 3

ASCEND TEST 7

Time Allowed: **Three Hours**

Maximum Marks: **250**

Question Paper Specific Instructions:

1. There are **TWENTY** questions printed in **ENGLISH**.
 2. All questions are compulsory.
 3. The number of marks carried by a question/part is indicated against it.
 4. Word limit in questions, if specified, should be adhered to.
 5. Any page or portion of the page left blank in the Question-Cum Answer Booklet must be clearly Struck off.
 6. Do furnish the appropriate details in the answer sheet (viz. Name, Email, Roll No, Mobile).
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- Q.1)** Discuss India's plan to establish its own space station and identify the key advancements required for the successful development and operation of this space station. (10 marks, 150 words)
- Q.2)** Highlight the diverse applications of nanotechnology in various fields. Also, discuss the potential issues that need to be addressed for effective use of nanotechnology. (10 Marks, 150 Words)
- Q.3)** Discuss how Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) can contribute to India's growth trajectory, and also address the concerns associated with it. Provide suitable illustrations to support your answer. (10 marks, 150 words)
- Q.4)** Highlight the impact of marine pollution on the coastal biodiversity of India. What steps can be taken to mitigate this pollution and protect the biodiversity? (10 marks, 150 words)
- Q.5)** What are the natural and anthropogenic factors that trigger landslides? Suggest measures to mitigate them effectively. (10 marks, 150 words)
- Q.6)** The devastating urban floods in India have highlighted the complex interplay between climate change, urbanization, and infrastructural deficiencies. Discuss (10 marks, 150 words)
- Q.7)** Analyse how urban heat islands (UHI) exacerbate the effects of climate change in urban areas. Suggest measures to mitigate Urban Heat Island effect. (10 marks, 150 words)

- Q.8)** Discuss the causes of increasing frequency of extreme weather events in India. What steps can be taken to improve disaster preparedness and response to these events?
(10 marks, 150 words)
- Q.9)** Organized crime is often both a product of and contributor to conflict in vulnerable states. Discuss
(10 marks, 150 words)
- Q.10)** India's vast coastline and inbuilt deficiencies have made coastal security daunting task. Elaborate.
(10 marks, 150 words)
- Q.11)** Discuss the concept of gene therapy and its potential benefits for treating genetic diseases. Also, highlight the challenges associated with gene therapy and suggest measures to address these challenges.
(15 marks, 250 words)
- Q.12)** 'Biotechnology has the potential to make agricultural practices sustainable.' In this context, what are the potential benefits and risks associated with adopting genetically modified (GM) crops?
(15 marks, 250 words)
- Q.13)** What is Quantum Supremacy? Highlight potential applications of quantum computing across various sectors also discuss the key challenges associated with the development of quantum computers.
(15 marks, 250 words)
- Q.14)** Discuss the causes and consequences of groundwater depletion in India. Also, suggest measures to promote sustainable groundwater management.
(15 marks, 250 words)
- Q.15)** 'Western Ghats are to be declared as an Ecologically Sensitive Area (ESA).' In this context, highlight the recommendations by the Gadgil committee to conserve western Ghats.
(15 marks, 250 words)
- Q.16)** Examine the major challenges and shortcomings associated with the Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) in India. Suggest measures to address these issues effectively.
(15 marks, 250 words)
- Q.17)** 'Mangrove forests play a crucial role in maintaining ecological balance and providing numerous environmental benefits.' In this context, examine both natural and anthropogenic threats to mangrove ecosystems in India.
(15 marks, 250 words)
- Q.18)** Highlight the institutional framework of disaster management in India and outline the issues associated with it. Also, suggest measures to address these issues.
(15 marks, 250 words)
- Q.19)** The causes of Left-Wing Extremism go beyond alienation and underdevelopment. Discuss the efficacy of recent initiative taken to tackle Left-Wing Extremism.
(15 marks, 250 words)
- Q.20)** Highlight the role of external state and non-state actors in posing threats to India's internal security. Also, enumerate some of the measures taken by India to address these challenges.
(15 Marks, 250 Words)